Tutorial 5

Company Thesis Lab: BlackBerry, Marvell, Hims & Hers, and Tesla

A student-ready module for turning a story stock into a sourced investment thesis.

Module purpose

Prepared from the April 21, 2026 class transcript. Original discussion anchor: Adel discussed Marvell, Hims & Hers, and BlackBerry as investment research names, framed BlackBerry as an underdog/software turnaround, connected Hims & Hers to telehealth and GLP-1/peptide regulation, and connected Tesla to robotics and manufacturing conversion. Educational material only - not investment advice.

Ideal length	Audience	Student output
90-120 minutes	Beginner to intermediate market students	One story-vs-evidence thesis card

1. Lesson snapshot

What the live conversation was really about

The conversation used BlackBerry, Marvell, Hims & Hers, and Tesla as examples of companies that might be researched for investment rather than traded intraday. The student-ready version is not: "buy the underdog" or "buy the theme." The student-ready version is: turn every story into evidence, then decide whether the evidence is strong enough to keep studying.

Conversation idea	Student-ready version	Teaching reason
BlackBerry as an underdog comeback	Treat it as a turnaround thesis. Validate the current segments, margins, backlog, customer mix, and risks before using nostalgia as evidence.	A strong memory of the phone brand is not a business thesis.
Marvell as a semiconductor / AI infrastructure name	Map the company to data centers, custom silicon, networking, storage, and customer concentration.	AI demand is a theme; students must identify which part of the value chain a company actually owns.
Hims & Hers as telehealth, GLP-1, and peptide exposure	Separate the platform thesis from product-specific regulatory risk, pharmacy risk, marketing risk, and subscriber economics.	Healthcare growth stories can be changed quickly by FDA, prescribing, pharmacy, and payer rules.
Tesla as robotics and manufacturing conversion, not just EVs	Track evidence around deliveries, energy storage, FSD/robotaxi, Optimus, capex, and factory conversion milestones.	A future product can support a thesis only if students define what proof would confirm or disconfirm it.

2. Learning objectives

- Write a one-sentence company thesis without confusing a story with proof.
- Use the 10-K, 10-Q, 8-K, investor presentation, and earnings call as primary-source evidence.
- Separate trading setups from long-term investment research.
- Identify the business engine, financial engine, catalyst engine, and risk engine for a public company.
- Create a falsification checklist: the facts that would prove the thesis wrong.

3. The thesis machine: story -> evidence -> decision

A company thesis should move through the same machine every time. Beginners often stop at the story: "this company is an underdog," "AI demand is huge," or "telehealth is the future." A serious research note keeps going until the story is supported, measured, challenged, and placed in a timeframe.

Step	Question	Student output
1. Story	What is the simple claim?	One sentence: "I believe X because Y should create Z."
2. Business engine	How does the company actually make money?	Segments, customers, revenue model, margin structure.
3. Evidence	What primary-source facts support the claim?	Three filing-backed facts with source names and dates.
4. Catalyst	What could make the market care?	Earnings, product launch, regulation, contract, margin inflection, guidance.
5. Risk	What could break the thesis?	Falsification checklist and risk ranking.
6. Valuation	What is already priced in?	Simple comparison: growth, margins, cash flow, multiple, or scenario value.
7. Decision	Is this a trade, watchlist name, or investment candidate?	Action label plus next research task. No automatic buy signal.

Teaching phrase

A story gets a student interested. Evidence decides whether the story deserves capital, more research, or deletion from the watchlist.

4. Company case matrix

Use these companies as labs, not recommendations. The point is to train the research process. All company facts should be refreshed from the latest filings before class because businesses, regulation, and guidance can change quickly.

Company	Thesis type	What students should verify	Primary evidence to pull
BlackBerry (BB)	Turnaround / embedded software / secure communications	QNX adoption, royalty backlog, secure communications demand, revenue quality, margins, cash flow, patent licensing, customer concentration.	Latest 10-K and 10-Q; QNX, Secure Communications, and Licensing segment notes; risk factors; earnings call.
Marvell (MRVL)	AI data infrastructure / custom silicon / connectivity	Data-center mix, custom semiconductor programs, networking and optical interconnect exposure, customer concentration, gross margins, capex cycle sensitivity.	Latest 10-K; segment/end-market tables; earnings release; customer and acquisition disclosures.
Hims & Hers (HIMS)	Digital health platform / consumer healthcare / regulatory growth	Subscriber growth, retention, CAC, margin, product mix, GLP-1 strategy, compounding rules, pharmacy partners, medical/legal compliance.	10-K; shareholder letters; FDA communications; company GLP-1 strategy releases; risk factors.
Tesla (TSLA)	EV + energy + autonomy + physical AI	Auto deliveries and margins, energy storage deployments, regulatory credits, FSD/robotaxi evidence, Optimus milestones, capex, factory conversion.	10-K; quarterly update deck; production/delivery releases; AI/robotics page; risk factors.

5. Story vs. evidence worksheet

Students should fill this before they are allowed to say "I like the stock." Require at least one primary source per evidence line.

Claim	Evidence required	Where to find it	Student note
BB is a real software turnaround, not just a nostalgia brand.	Segment growth, profitability, QNX backlog/adoption, secure communications demand, cash flow.	10-K, quarterly release, earnings call transcript.	
MRVL benefits from AI infrastructure buildout.	Revenue mix, data-center growth, custom silicon evidence, optical/networking product traction, customer risk.	10-K, 8-K earnings release, investor deck.	
HIMS can use its customer base to expand regulated care.	Subscriber growth, revenue per subscriber, medical compliance, pharmacy structure, FDA status of key products.	10-K, FDA pages, company GLP-1/peptide updates.	
TSLA can become a physical AI company.	Production line ramp, capex, robotaxi/FSD evidence, Optimus milestones, energy storage growth, auto margin resilience.	10-K, quarterly update, production releases, AI/robotics page.	

6. The research workflow

A. Start with the filing, not the chart

- Open the latest 10-K and search for: business, segments, revenue, risk factors, customers, liquidity, debt, and management discussion.
- Open the latest 10-Q or quarterly update and ask what changed since the annual report.
- Open the last 8-K earnings release and record headline numbers, guidance, and management tone.
- Only after that, check the chart to see whether the market is confirming, ignoring, or rejecting the thesis.

B. Build the one-page thesis card

Field	What to write
Company and ticker	Company name, ticker, exchange, fiscal year, and latest filing date.
One-sentence thesis	The story in plain English.
Three facts	Three primary-source facts with source names.
Two catalysts	What could make the market care in the next 3, 6, or 12 months.
Two risks	What would invalidate the thesis or force a smaller position.

Field	What to write
Watch level	Price or fundamental level that tells the student the market is changing its mind.
Next action	Research more, paper-watch, compare peers, or reject.

7. Red flags that should stop the thesis

Red flag	Why it matters	Student correction
The thesis depends on admiration for a CEO.	A founder story is not a cash-flow model.	Convert admiration into measurable milestones.
The student cannot name the business segments.	They do not know what they are buying.	Read the business and segment footnotes before discussing valuation.
The thesis ignores regulation.	Healthcare, AI, autos, and semiconductors are policy-sensitive.	Create a regulation map before assigning a long-term view.
The company needs perfect execution.	A thesis with no margin of safety can fail even if the story is directionally right.	Write the base case, downside case, and proof required for upside.
The student says "everyone on social media is talking about it."	Attention is not evidence.	Treat social sentiment as a lead, then verify with filings.

8. Classroom exercise

Assign each student one of the four companies. They must complete the thesis card and then present both a bull case and a bear case. The bear case must be strong enough that someone who disagrees with the thesis would say it is fair.

Deliverable	Requirement
One-sentence thesis	No buzzwords unless defined. Example: "Marvell is a data-center semiconductor thesis because..."
Evidence table	At least three facts, each sourced from filings, regulator pages, or official company materials.
Risk map	At least three risks ranked high, medium, low.
Falsification trigger	One measurable event that would make the student stop liking the thesis.
Peer comparison	One competitor or substitute company and why it might be better or worse.

9. AI research prompts

- For this company, summarize the current business segments using only the latest 10-K and 10-Q. Quote no more than three short phrases and cite the filing sections.
- Create a bull case, bear case, and base case. For every claim, mark whether it is supported by a filing, company presentation, regulator source, news source, or unsourced assumption.
- List five facts that would falsify this thesis over the next year. Make them measurable.
- Compare this company with two peers. Separate business model, growth, margin, balance sheet, valuation, and regulatory risk.

10. Assessment rubric

Skill	Excellent	Needs work
Business understanding	Student can explain how revenue and margin are produced.	Student repeats a theme without naming segments.
Evidence discipline	Every key claim has a primary source.	Claims rely on social media, headlines, or memory.
Risk thinking	Student identifies risks that could break the thesis.	Student lists generic risks with no connection to the business.
Timeframe	Student separates trade setup, watchlist, and investment thesis.	Student mixes intraday movement with multi-year claims.

Source-backed reading list

Use these sources to complement the transcript. Students should prefer primary filings, regulator pages, and official product documentation before social media or summaries.

[1] SEC Investor.gov, "How to Read a 10-K/10-Q" - explains that 10-Ks and 10-Qs provide a detailed picture of a company's business, risks, and operating results.

[2] BlackBerry Limited FY2026 Form 10-K / SEC filing - current segment structure and QNX, Secure Communications, and Licensing disclosures.

[3] Marvell Technology FY2026 Form 10-K / SEC filing - business description of custom semiconductor solutions for AI, data center, compute, networking, carrier, storage, aerospace, and defense applications.

[4] Marvell Technology FY2026 results release - fiscal 2026 revenue and profit context.

[5] Hims & Hers Health 2025 Form 10-K / SEC filing - digital platform, treatment categories, licensed professionals, and online pharmacy fulfillment model.

[6] Hims & Hers FY2025 results release - full-year revenue, subscriber count, net income, adjusted EBITDA, and guidance context.

[7] Hims & Hers GLP-1 strategy updates and FDA GLP-1 compounding communications - regulatory context for weight-loss and compounding exposure.

[8] Tesla 2025 Form 10-K / SEC filing - production line ramp across vehicles, Bots, energy storage, and battery manufacturing.

[9] Tesla AI and Robotics page - Optimus description and engineering focus areas.

Instructor reminder

Keep every company in this module as a case study unless the student is operating inside a formal advisory relationship. The goal is research skill, not stock picking.